

Agency Mission

The Texas Education Agency will improve outcomes for all public school students in the state by providing leadership, guidance, and support to school systems.

Agency Vision

Every child, prepared for success in college, a career, or the military.

Agency Operational Goals and Action Plans

Strategic Priority One: Recruit, Support and Retain Teacher and Principals

Strong classroom instruction, supported by effective instructional leaders, makes a tremendous difference in ensuring that students are progressing to achieve the state's vision of preparing the public school students in Texas for success in college, career, or the military. To accomplish this, the agency will strengthen the teacher pipeline every step of the way and support the development of principals statewide.

Specific Action Items to Achieve Strategic Priority One

1. By June 2025, the agency will scale a teacher designation framework that helps attract and retain high-performing teachers and allows districts to identify their more effective educators and then provide incentives for them to teach at their most challenged campuses, increasing the equitable distribution of effective educators. This Teacher Incentive Allotment (TIA) was made possible by House Bill 3 (86th Regular Legislative Session) and is designed to address the declining interest in the teaching profession because of low compensation and the growing numbers of high-needs students that are served by inexperienced teachers. TIA allows Texas teachers to be designated as Recognized, Exemplary, or Master teachers based on performance standards that are grounded in teacher observations, and student performance. The state's highest performing teachers then receive salary increases commensurate to their designation under the TIA. In the next five years, the agency will upgrade the Strategic Compensation Online Management System to allow districts to independently view and track designated teachers and district allotments and will support districts with implementation and growth of their systems by refining program materials, creating turn-key student growth resources that apply to all eligible teaching assignments, providing technical assistance to regional service centers, Technical Assistance providers, and districts, and building salary-based incentive systems as a part of a district's larger talent strategy. The agency will also update TIA systems and T-TESS to align with the High-Quality Instructional Materials standards.
2. The Curriculum and Instruction Integrated Supports initiative supports districts in establishing a research-based instructional framework, assessing their current practices and systems related to Tier 1 curriculum and instruction, and identifying and implementing strong curriculum and instruction strategies and supporting capacity building across multiple LEA roles from teachers in the classroom to executive district leadership. Several guiding principles the agency holds that shape this initiative include supporting teacher internalization and delivery of High-Quality Instructional Materials (HQIM) and providing instructional leadership and job-embedded instructional coaching supports. This initiative includes High-Quality Professional Learning (HQPL) on instructional materials for all levels including onboarding and ongoing professional learning for teachers, instructional coaches, and instructional leaders through asynchronous modules with additional supports to apply learning.
3. By August 2025, the agency will redesign the teacher certification framework with a focus on increasing the rigor, relevancy, reliability, and validity of the certification assessments by introducing assessments that place a greater emphasis on valid, authentic practice (especially in content pedagogy). Content assessments will be updated to include increased content pedagogy to be assessed through both multiple choice and constructed response questions, and pedagogy assessments will include actual demonstration of skills in Texas

achievement academy,” or Reading Academies. By December 2023, over 132,000 educators completed the Texas Reading Academies. Starting in Year 4 (2023-2024), the agency will adjust implementation based on qualitative and quantitative data to support a more positive learning experience. Among other changes, this includes the launch of a working group of EPPs to pilot Reading Academies with their candidates and contribute to planning for statewide (voluntary) implementation in the 2024-2025 school year.

8. House Bill 3 (88th Regular Legislative Session) established the Office of School Safety and Security in the agency to work in coordination with the Texas School Safety Center and with regional service centers to provide ongoing support and oversight of LEA safety practices. Senate Bill 30 (88th Regular Legislative Session) allocated \$1.1 billion in supplemental appropriation for school safety facility standards to ensure full funding for all campuses to comply with minimum safety standards. Over the next five years, the agency will continue to provide technical assistance and guidance to Texas schools in implementing the school safety policies passed by the Legislature.
9. Throughout the next five years, the agency will continue to investigate and issue sanctions against educator misconduct to ensure student safety and uphold the integrity of the teaching profession.

How Goal or Action Items Support Each Statewide Objective

1. ***Accountable to tax and fee payers of Texas.*** These initiatives are designed to leverage resources to the fullest potential and impact educators and principals across the state to ensure high-quality preparation and support of the people who have the greatest impact on our students.
2. ***Efficient such that maximum results are produced with a minimum waste of taxpayer funds, including through the elimination of redundant and non-core functions.*** These initiatives were designed to support the agency’s priority of recruiting, supporting, and retaining principals and teachers. The agency has sought opportunities to leverage existing funds and partner with our regional education service centers and other stakeholders. The blended model of the Reading Academies centralizes all content and screening processes and delivers the highest quality content while saving costs both for the state and for districts.
3. ***Effective in successfully fulfilling core functions, measuring success in achieving performance measures, and implementing plans to continuously improve.*** These action items are directly aligned with the agency’s core function to ensure that each child in the state of Texas has quality educators. The agency has created project milestones and performance metrics for each initiative to make data-driven decisions about current and upcoming work.
4. ***Attentive to providing excellent customer service.*** While developing the agency's strategic priorities, the agency drew upon comments we heard across the state on how we can help improve our teacher and principal pool and pipeline. This priority is a result of those comments, and the agency will continue to solicit feedback and engage stakeholders throughout the life of these projects.
5. ***Transparent such that agency actions can be understood by any Texan.*** The agency has developed web resources that explain to all Texans how the House Bill 3 (88th Regular Legislative Session) school safety standards are being implemented through webinars, guidelines, and update videos. All the agency’s initiatives have developed strong performance metrics that measure the progress of the highest priority work. The agency also provides an

update to all stakeholders through an Annual Report on the progress being made towards the Strategic Priority initiatives.

Strategic Priority Two: Build a Foundation of Reading and Math

Building proficiency in reading and math begins with kindergarten readiness, but it does not stop there—ensuring students in 3rd and 8th grade demonstrate the ability to meet grade level standards in reading and math has a long-term positive impact on student outcomes and helps prevent expensive taxpayer-funded remediation later in life.

Specific Action Items to Achieve Strategic Priority Two

1. The Agency has identified two kindergarten readiness instruments in English and Spanish that are freely available to districts. In 1st and 2nd grades, the Agency has three freely available literacy diagnostic tools. To support a strong foundation in reading for all students, progress toward literacy must be consistently and meaningfully measured as students progress from early grades through elementary school. These tools will measure reading development and allow teachers to better understand and support their students' performance. Teachers and other relevant district personnel will also receive a wide variety of training to support their implementation of the diagnostic tools and use of associated student data to inform instructional practices.
3. The Strong Foundations grant program was funded by the Legislature (TEC Sec. 29.0881.(a)) to provide content and implementation supports for school systems. Content planning support includes technical assistance to district leadership teams on math and literacy cognitive science, instructional materials best practices, extended school year scheduling, early childhood systems, and instructional leadership strategic planning. Implementation supports include summer and year-long job-embedded training and technical assistance for district and school administrators, coaches and teachers aligned to state-owned evidence-based math and literacy high-quality instructional materials. The agency is administering this grant program via the Learning Acceleration Supports Opportunities (LASO) grant. In 2024-2025, the COVID Recovery Instructional Materials Support Initiative (CRIMSI) will no longer be available, and all implementation supports will be delivered through a Strong Foundations-Approved Provider List (SFAPL) of regional service centers and other technical assistance providers.
4. Through 2029, the agency will provide districts, schools and teachers with high-quality guaranteed, viable, and customizable instructional materials (including digital tools), along with implementation and training support, at no cost. These materials will both align to state standards and be high-quality to provide meaningful instructional support. Instructional materials are one of the most important tools that educators use in the classroom to improve and support student achievement. A growing body of research points to the positive impact high-quality instructional materials have on student learning. The agency will support the development of high-quality Open Education Resource (OER) Texas-specific instructional materials and curricular resources for PreK-12 English and Math. Additionally, House Bill 1605 (88th Regular Legislative Session) established a process for the State board of Education (SBOE) to review and approve materials supported by the agency and established additional funding (on top of the Instructional Materials and Technology Allotment) provided to districts who choose to use SBOE approved materials. This bill requires the agency to develop state-owned textbooks in certain grades & subjects, which are subject to approval by the State Board

of Education (SBOE).

5. In line with House Bill 3906 (86th Regular Legislative Session) requirements, the agency has created free, optional assessment resources that support districts throughout the year. The STAAR Interim Assessments are online interim assessments (or benchmark tests), aligned to the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS), that allow educators to monitor student progress on grade-level standards, understand students' expected performance on STAAR, and identify students who need more targeted supports. The Texas Formative Assessment Resource (TFAR), launched in 2021-2022 with STAAR Interim Assessments, is an online platform that supports districts' existing formative assessment practices by allowing educators to create, share, administer, and analyze curricular-aligned, formative assessments.
6. The agency will continue to administer a valid and reliable mechanism to measure student mastery of core TEKS content areas. State and federal laws, including House Bill 3906 (86th Regular Legislative Session), required a redesign of Texas' state summative assessment (STAAR) and other transformative changes to improve the STAAR program by aligning the assessment to the classroom experience, improving the depth and quality of assessments items, and including item types that allow students to demonstrate proficiency of the standards using higher order thinking skills. These changes, including moving to online assessment administration, were effective starting the 2022-2023 school year and are providing timely and informative data on student performance that is used by educators to inform instructional decision-making and by families to support their students.
7. In line with House Bill 3906 requirements, the agency is conducting a Through-Year Assessment Pilot, which launched in 2022-2023. This multi-part, through-year assessment pilot aims to generate a cumulative score like STAAR and someday replace STAAR as Texas's summative assessment. Any participation by districts is optional and does not eliminate a district's obligation to administer the STAAR test. The pilot will be rolled out over multiple years prior to potential adoption to ensure validity of the design and stakeholder feedback. In 2023-2024 (Year 2), 93 LEAs from 19 out of 20 educational service regions participated in the pilot. The earliest decision by the Legislature for STAAR replacement will be made upon the 2025-2026 (Year 4) pilot report.

How Goal or Action Items Support Each Statewide Objective

1. ***Accountable to tax and fee payers of Texas.*** This body of priority initiatives is designed to support teachers across all grades and subjects, in providing high-quality instruction to all Texas students and improve student outcomes. These investments in early education and for the full K-12 pathway are grounded firmly in best-in-class research on high quality instruction. This will prepare Texas teachers to have the greatest impact on student outcomes, curtail the need for remediation, and cut costs associated with low student attainment in core foundational skills.
2. ***Efficient such that maximum results are produced with a minimum waste of taxpayer funds, including through the elimination of redundant and non-core functions.*** The agency is maximizing existing dollars and leveraging resources to reach the greatest number of teachers who benefit from this content.
3. ***Effective in successfully fulfilling core functions, measuring success in achieving performance measures, and implementing plans to continuously improve.*** All Strategic Priority Two action items support provisions laid out in the education code around our youngest Texas students in prekindergarten and established some of the agency's core functions, such

updated list of Industry-Based Certifications for public school accountability will be developed for release, coinciding with implementation of the refreshed CTE Programs of Study. The Programs of Study incorporate a coherent and scaffolded sequence of courses, work-based learning experiences, and relevant, stackable credentials, particularly Industry-Based Certifications. The Programs of Study were refreshed through a robust cross-sector stakeholder engagement process throughout the Spring of 2023, and the proposed updates will be implemented in the 2024-2025 school year.

3. Through 2029, the Agency will continue to support and expand its work around College and Career Readiness School Models (CCRSM). In the 87th legislative session, the legislature allocated \$51 million through House Bill 1525 for intensive educational supports for expanded learning opportunities for one of the CCRSM school models - Pathways in Technology Early College High Schools (P-TECH). The P-TECH program provides a smooth transitional experience for students from high school to postsecondary education and employment. Specifically, this model serves students who are at-risk of dropping out (TEC §29.081) and offers open enrollment and at no cost to students. It provides students with an opportunity to earn postsecondary credentials and/or industry-based certifications. Participation in this model requires a memorandum of understanding (MOU) with an Institution of Higher Education, an MOU with Business and Industry, and alignment to regional workforce needs. Students receive work-based learning at every grade level and have up to 6 years to earn a High School Diploma and a certification and/or postsecondary degree.
4. Through 2029, the agency will continue to expand the Texas Regional Pathways Network (TRPN) to cover more regions in the state. In the 87th legislative session, the legislature allocated funding through House Bill 1525 that allows for the expansion of TRPN. This expansion will focus on ensuring that regional conveners will support and facilitate key stakeholder partnerships (e.g. districts, institutions of higher education, industry partners, and community partners) and enable them to collaborate to provide comprehensive, high-quality P-20 Pathways for students. These pathways align the educational goals of Texas with 60x30TX and enable students to transition seamlessly through high school into postsecondary education and careers – particularly in high-demand, high-wage sectors. The Texas Regional Pathways Network focuses on supporting districts, with the support of tri-agency partners and other key stakeholders, to provide pathways which include college credit opportunities in high school, industry-based certifications, work-based learning opportunities, and high-quality advising beginning in early grades.
5. The agency will continue to gather relevant, valid, and reliable information about college, career, and military readiness among student in grades K-12 and will gather relevant financial, operational, and programmatic information about school systems in the most critical areas. The agency will ensure appropriate quality controls are in place so that all information gathered is accurate.

How Goal or Action Items Support Each Statewide Objective

1. ***Accountable to tax and fee payers of Texas.*** The agency's Strategic Priority 3 initiatives are designed to collectively achieve the 60x30TX goal and meet the college, career, and military preparedness vision outlined in HB3. Investments in college and career readiness will support more students in meeting the state's economic development needs as they move into post-secondary and reduce the cost of higher education and remediation costs and other costs associated with low student attainment in core foundational skills for taxpayers.

2. Texas Strategic Leadership (TSL) will embed a board-integrated pathway aligned to Lone Star Governance (LSG) content and seeks to provide an integrated service experience with the System of Great Schools (SGS), which is inclusive of the Effective District Framework (EDF). The EDF will provide an opportunity for districts in the state of Texas to reflect and analyze current practices to support continuous improvement planning for student success. Aligned to the established levers within the Effective Schools Framework (ESF), the EDF will support districts in three phases of sequential work that will improve their ability to effectively implement the high-leverage systems and practices that accelerate student learning: 1) assess current district practices against evidence-based practices; 2) identify a best-fit strategy for districts to improve implementation of high-leverage systems and practices; and 3) develop, identify, and cultivate best-in-class supports for districts aligned to their strategy and needs. The destination for EDF district-level performance management support is to ensure districts can create actionable continuous improvement plans and access capacity-building supports aligned to high-leverage systems and practices, resulting in the improvement of the districts' ability to implement their mission and achieve their vision. In 2024-2025, the agency will roll out the Organizational Performance Management Pilot, integrate the TSL/EDF work with board support, and provide districts with multiple diagnostic options.
3. Over the next five years, the agency will continue promoting a continuous-improvement model for governing teams (school boards with their superintendents) that choose to focus on improving student outcomes. Aligned to the State Board of Education's Texas Framework for School Board Development, Lone Star Governance (LSG) is a research-based, comprehensive in-field model in which certified coaches work directly with school board members. From high-performing boards with exceptional student outcomes to governing teams beginning their journey to greatness, LSG provides tools, resources, and best practices to support boards across the continuum of performance to improve results for their students.
4. System of Great Schools (SGS) ensures that more Texas students are served by coherent, high-quality, best-fit schools every year, year over year. The 20-plus member districts pursuing SGS will receive a 4-year capacity building support to: 1) conduct an annual portfolio planning process to assess school performance and community need/demand; 2) use this analysis to decide which campuses should be improved, redesigned, restarted, and which new schools should be created; and 3) take bold action to create and expand great options.
5. The Supplemental Special Education Services (SSES) benefits students with disabilities by using parent-directed spending accounts to purchase high quality goods and services to support the individual needs of their student. SSES serves to improve outcomes for students with disabilities and to increase parent engagement in their child's education. House Bill 1926 (88th Regular Legislative Session) removed the expiration date of 2024 from the statute to make SSES a permanent program. Additionally, there is no longer a funding cap. These changes are expected to reduce the size of eligible students on waitlists for services. In addition to administering SSES, over the next five years, the agency will build a set of standalone professional development, job-embedded professional development and consulting services via regional service centers and other partners that provide specialized and systems-level support to LEAs based on standardized special education performance diagnostic, self-administered and supported via monitoring, intended to improve special education compliance and to improve outcomes for students with disabilities.
6. Texas law requires all students who do not achieve approaches or higher on STAAR in grade 3 through 8 or on the high school EOC assessments be provided accelerated instruction. House Bill 1416 (88th Regular Legislative Session) modified these requirements by eliminating

to Technology
 Strategy: B.2.1., Technology/Instructional Materials
 Type: Outcome Measure
 Definition: This measure reflects the percentage of district instructional materials allotment (IMA) purchases related to technology including equipment.
 Purpose: The purpose of this measure is to identify the percentage of the IMA that is spent statewide on technology.
 Data Source: EMAT
 Method of Calculation: The measure is calculated by dividing the amount of IMA funding spent statewide on technology by the total amount of IMA funding spent by districts and charter schools in a given year.
 Data Limitations: None
 Calculation Type: Noncumulative
 New measure: No
 Desired Performance: Higher than target.

2.2.9 PERCENT OF DISTRICT INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS ALLOTMENT (IMA) PURCHASES RELATED TO SUPPORT MATERIAL TECHNOLOGY PERSONNEL

Title: Percent of District Instructional Materials Allotment (IMA) Purchases Related to Support Material Technology Personnel
 Strategy: B.2.1., Technology/Instructional Materials
 Type: Outcome Measure
 Definition: This measure reflects the percentage of district instructional materials allotment (IMA) purchases related to support material/technology personnel.
 Purpose: The purpose of this measure is to identify the percentage of the IMA that is spent statewide on support material/technology personnel.
 Data Source: EMAT
 Method of Calculation: The measure is calculated by dividing the amount of IMA funding spent statewide on support material/technology personnel by the total amount of IMA funding spent by districts and charter schools in a given year.
 Data Limitations: None
 Calculation Type: Noncumulative
 New measure: No
 Desired Performance: Higher than target.

2.2.10 PERCENT OF TEC §48.308 ENTITLEMENT FUNDS DRAWN DOWN

Title: Percent of TEC §48.308 Entitlements Funds Drawn Down
 Strategy: B.2.1., Technology/Instructional Materials
 Type: Outcome Measure
 Definition: This measure reflects the percentage of district entitlement funds under the Texas Education Code (TEC) §48.308 (\$20 per student Open Education Resources Printing Allotment) drawn down by Local Education Agencies (LEAs).
 Purpose: The purpose of this measure is to identify the extent to which LEAs access one of the instructional material entitlements created by House Bill 1605, 88-R.
 Data Source: EMAT
 Method of Calculation: The measure is calculated by dividing the amount of TEC §48.308 funds draw down by LEAs in a given year by the total amount of funding made

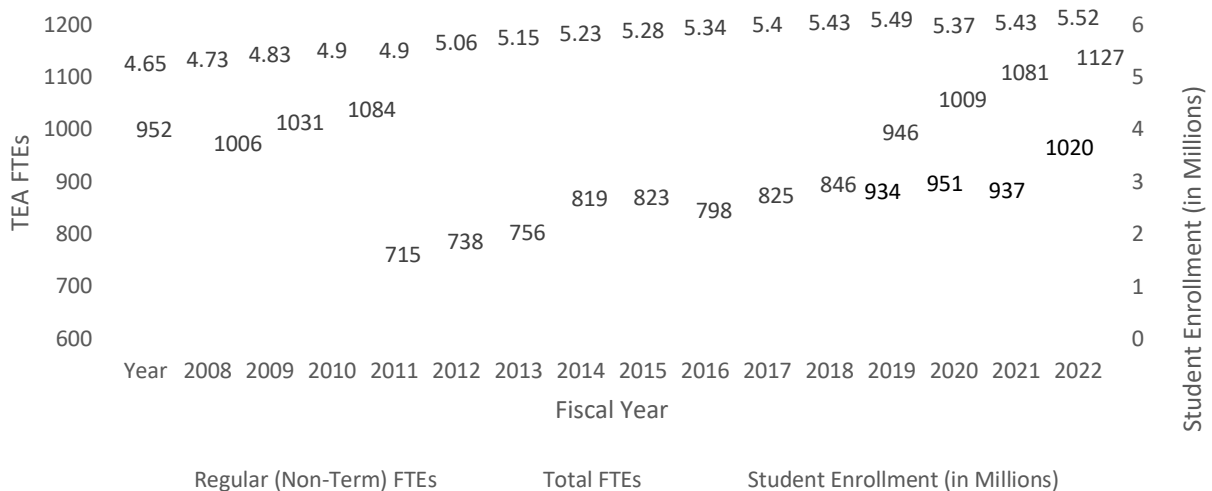
Supplemental Schedule F: Agency Workforce Plan

Public education is the largest function of the state and of most local governments. The Texas Education Agency is responsible for serving nearly 5.52 million students enrolled in 9,054 campuses that are administered by 1,209 school districts and open-enrollment charters schools.¹ The number of Texas public school students has increased about 9 percent over the last decade.²

During the FY2022-2023 biennium, TEA distributed approximately \$63 billion to local education agencies (LEAs) through numerous state and federal programs, while also providing hundreds of millions of dollars more in additional value to LEAs through services and in-kind supports. This includes the agency's ongoing administration of a massive influx of funding for COVID-19 pandemic relief. Across federal and state sources and several state agencies, well over \$21 billion has been provided since FY2020 to support a comprehensive response and recovery plan. Texas educators and policymakers are prioritizing changes to support improved student learning, and public policy has been adapted to improve learning acceleration efforts. School leaders across the state are recalibrating their practices based on the evidence of what will deliver the most learning gains for the most students.

When compared to other large state agencies with significant responsibilities and complicated programs, TEA has relatively few full-time equivalent positions (FTEs). Figure 1 shows the agency's FTEs over time and separates regular (non-term) positions from term roles scheduled to end in the next 1- 3 years. Increases since 2018 were associated primarily with special education corrective actions; implementation of House Bill (HB) 3 (86-R), administration of federal and state programs to recover from learning loss caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, addition of curriculum and instructional materials programs in HB 1605 (88-R) and school safety programs in HB 3 (88-R), and strategic insourcing of certain information technology (IT) functions.

Figure 1: TEA Full-Time Equivalent Positions and Student Enrollment, 2008-2023



Source: Fiscal Years 2008-2013 based on Texas State Auditor's Office FTE Report. Fiscal Year 2014-23 based on Texas State Auditor's Office FTE Dashboard

¹ TEA Pocket Edition, 2022-2023, ² Enrollment in Texas Public Schools 2022-23